



Odin wasted no time. He took his spear and plunged it into his side, then hung himself upside-down from the branches of the World Tree. Refusing any help, he glared unblinking into the Well of Urd's waters, which slowly turned red as his life-blood drained into it.

*After nine nights of agony, Odin saw what had been hidden: the shape of the runes and the priceless secrets they carried.*

In his perfect memory Odin now held the power to heal wounds, trap enemies and make their weapons useless, protect his allies in battle and even bring the dead back to life. "Let the giants and trolls fight me now," he said with a triumphant smile. "They don't stand a chance."